

Interviewer [00:00:01] Yes, do you agree to participate in the study in accordance with the informed consent form I sent you today?

Speaker [00:00:08] I do.

Interviewer [00:00:09] Okay. First of all, I will ask you a few demographic questions, how old are you?

Speaker [00:00:15] [26-30].

Interviewer [00:00:16] [26-30]. How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker [00:00:21] [1-5] months.

Interviewer [00:00:24] [1-5] months. Do you have children?

Speaker [00:00:25] No.

Interviewer [00:00:26] Who do you live with at home?

Speaker [00:00:29] I have a [name].

Interviewer [00:00:31] What is your main source of income?

Speaker [00:00:36] I have been [occupation] for [1-5] months.

Interviewer [00:00:38] Okay.

Speaker [00:00:38] but I'm normally in the [field] sector.

Interviewer [00:00:40] Okay. What would you like me to call your partner? Partner, lover, spouse.

Speaker [00:00:48] Not spouse, partner or lover.

Interviewer [00:00:51] Okay. Now I'm going to ask some questions in a romantic context. Can you tell me the story of how you met and how your relationship started?

Speaker [00:01:00] E. Well I was at a [event] with my friends at [Location]. Since I've told this story [50-55] thousand times, I've been trying to figure out how to do something different, but I can't. Then, just as we were finishing, she came with her fan. The instrumentalists started to accompany her and I said, "Who is this woman?" That's how we met. Then, [1-5] months later, we started dating officially.

Interviewer [00:01:36] After you met. Yes, how did your relationship develop after you met?

Speaker [00:01:44] Within that day?

Interviewer [00:01:45] How did the process of transforming to the relationship develop afterwards?

Speaker [00:01:53] First of all, you know, I mentioned that I didn't want a relationship at first. Then [1-5] days later, it was also fine for her and she said that we could take it more slowly from now on and so on. I guess when I felt that atmosphere of trust, my friend asked me out [1-5] days later.

Interviewer [00:02:16] Okay. How would you rate the quality of your relationship compared to your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:02:24] So quality has many, many dimensions. I wondered what you mean by quality.

Interviewer [00:02:33] I'm afraid I can't say that because the purpose of this study is to investigate relationship quality, but actually the purpose of our research is to try to assess what you understand by relationship quality, to try to understand what relationship quality is.

Speaker [00:02:50] Uh-huh. Do I have to give a numerical answer then?

Interviewer [00:02:55] How you understand it yourself and how it makes you feel, how it makes you think.

Speaker [00:03:00] Uh-huh. E. Unlike my friends I guess, I mean... I'll be honest. I think it's more honest compared to hetero relationships. The way we talk. Other than that. We spend a lot of time together. This has both good and bad sides, because we can be closer, but at the same time, you know, setting boundaries is something we talked about earlier. This has its advantages. Apart from that, if... Hmm. I mean we can be more honest with each other. Apart from that, when there is a problem, we can talk directly. For example, partners experience different problems with each other's parents in a hetero relationship, as you can appreciate. Therefore, we can be more sensitive to problems with parents. We can support each other. You know, in career choices.

Interviewer [00:04:41] Can you give concrete examples here, for example, what kind of support processes are there in terms of career choices or supporting each other?

Speaker [00:04:51] I mean, in the last month, we have been working on a [company] with her, for example. First of all, I actually came out of a [company]. I was working as a [occupation] somewhere. I mean, she mentioned a project and while I didn't know exactly whether she would support it or not, I stopped a lot. I said, I want to support you. Then the process came organically, you know, let's do something together. I mean, for example, since it is something very much about well-being, at first, any person with a background in [program] can do something like, "Oh, this is all nonsense." I don't know. I don't know. It can support in this way. Apart from that, you know... I quit a job where I was exposed to mobbing a lot. There, she was listening and doing something like that, she was a little bit supportive.

Interviewer [00:05:56] So, for example, do you think these processes increased your relationship quality?

Speaker [00:06:02] Hm. It was a catalyst. Therefore, I don't think it directly increased the quality, but we were able to talk in a way that evolved for the better afterwards.

Interviewer [00:06:23] Hi. Well, you said that it did not increase directly. Well, for example, what were the indirect ways here? In other words, what do you think these processes led to and increased your work quality?

Speaker [00:06:35] For example, if I talk about this mobbing incident, she perceived the problems I had at work much more personally, and of course, there were a lot of things she was right about, but this is my job after all. The decisions I make. There were a lot of conversations between us on this. You know... This made us talk a little bit more clearly about what the boundaries were from the first [1-5] months. And this, you know, if we couldn't talk, and there are many examples I've seen, I've even experienced this directly in other relationships. I mean, events that can end instantly, events that can end relationships. But it strengthened us - that is, it raised its quality more. Because now we know each other better.

Interviewer [00:07:30] Can I also ask how many romantic relationships you had in the past?

Speaker [00:07:34] Sure, one minute. About [1-5].

Interviewer [00:07:41] Okay. And how would you rate the quality of your current relationship compared to your previous relationships?

Speaker [00:07:48] Hmmm. They were all very different relationships so I honestly don't know.

Interviewer [00:08:00] Well, for example, why do you think that- I interrupted.

Speaker [00:08:06] I mean I changed, I learned something from my other relationships. I mean, I had very problematic relationships. I had very good relationships, but I was very young at the time, blah blah blah. I don't know, I think it's because I'm someone who can't evaluate things on a scale.

Interviewer [00:08:32] So for example, is relationship quality something that cannot be evaluated on a scale?

Speaker [00:08:41] Yes.

Interviewer [00:08:43] Why do you think so?

Speaker [00:08:46] Because quality as a concept is multifaceted. I mean... And when you say quality, it's also like it's not clear which one you mean, past, future, present. I mean, you may feel good with someone now, but you know that it's not right for you, I mean, in [1-5] years or something like that.

Interviewer [00:09:16] Okay then. I mean, I understand that the quality of the relationship is divided into past, present and future and even if you feel that it is a very high quality relationship right now, we may think that that person is not right in the future and for this reason, our relationship quality can be divided into both good and bad. Am I right?

Speaker [00:09:39] So, for example, it can be a good relationship for the moment. I mean in this sense, for example, I was living in [Country A]. I had a [1-5]-year relationship that I considered to be of good quality, but I don't have it now. Well, because of geographical conditions. The things we both want from life have changed because we have grown up. And if we tried to be together now, we would have a poor quality relationship, because our expectations from each other have changed a lot.

Interviewer [00:10:11] Uh-huh uh-huh.

Speaker [00:10:14] Whether a person is right for you or not is something that changes a lot over time.

Interviewer [00:10:21] Uh-huh. Well, for example, in your previous answer you said that you have had beautiful and problematic relationships in the past. What were the elements that made those relationships beautiful and problematic?

Speaker [00:10:36] [Redacted]. What made it good was a relationship in which I could talk more clearly, the same as my current relationship. It lasted for [1-5] years anyway, you know. When there is a problem, I can say it instantly, without involving the ego or the other person. It was a relationship where I didn't offend the other person, or I talked because I didn't want to offend her, when we came back, I could honestly own it. Well... And also more, I mean, I can act like a friend a little more. Maybe it was a relationship where I could let down my guard.

Interviewer [00:11:37] So can you explain acting like a friend a little bit more?

Speaker [00:11:46] I mean, for something to be long-lasting, I mean, it's a very clichéd term, but you need to be a life partner. So support comes into it. Support, communication, trust.

Speaker [00:11:58] You know. Huh.

[00:11:58] Huh. I got distracted, sorry.

Interviewer [00:12:06] No, it's not important at all.

Speaker [00:12:06] What was the question?

Interviewer [00:12:09] Um. I asked if you could explain a little bit more about being like friends.

Speaker [00:12:14] I think that's all.

Interviewer [00:12:16] Okay. So what are the elements that make a relationship high quality for you? Or low quality.

Speaker 2 [00:12:28] What makes it low quality. The feeling of pressure from the other side. That is, one of the partners cannot convey their desires to the other person in such a clear way. That is, not taking what they say seriously, not listening to them. What makes quality, the relationship is already in every way. Patience, patience, can be perceived as a bit negative here, but maybe it can be translated as resilience, limit, I can't find the Turkish word for it. After all, after every difficulty, knowing that you are making progress and acting accordingly according to this concept of labor. Other than that, being friends and being interested in each other's interests, that is, spending time together. It's not just empty stuff like that. To be a person who will not be a person who will sit idly by just because of sexual attraction after a while. Somehow, you know, being an intellectual, you know, a person with whom you can have a dialog. Other than that... Not getting bored, I guess. Or when you're bored, well. I mean, being able to give each other time and space, and at the same time, being able to be one when we're together, and so on and so forth.

Interviewer [00:14:36] Could you elaborate on the concept of being one when you are together?

Speaker [00:14:40] Being able to be in a relationship without losing your own identity, or even spatially, when I look at it, two people can only do the things they want, their hobbies, etc. in the same room without disturbing each other.

Interviewer [00:14:59] Well, for example, one of your answers was resilience. How do you think a person can know that they are in a resilient relationship?

Speaker [00:15:10] I don't know in general, it seems like something that will be understood over time.

Interviewer [00:15:19] Okay. Again, you said something in one of them, you said it was ignored. When do you think your relationship was ignored? When did it happen the most or when do you feel ignored the least?

Speaker [00:15:44] I mean when I understood my own wants, my own needs, after I explained. I think that is very clear, I think. I guess you know. Since I have been in therapy for a couple of years. I mean, I can understand it more clearly now that I can explain my own needs, but I can understand it more clearly. I mean, it used to happen more when I was young. Now that I address it directly when I am ignored, I don't think it's too much anymore, but I don't think it's too much anymore.

Interviewer [00:16:17] For example, when more? I am very sorry, you go ahead.

Speaker [00:16:22] When? When I get interrupted a lot. Or when I have to repeat myself like ten times if what I need is something very simple. I guess when I try to express myself and it is not understood.

Interviewer [00:17:01] Okay. Your previous answers actually touched on some of these things, but I would like to ask you again since it is the main topic of our research project. If you don't mind, what are the most important things in a relationship for you?

Speaker [00:17:15] What are the important things? But probably communication. Apart from that. Maybe curiosity, curiosity to understand and get to know each other. Other than that. Love (sevgi), respect, mutual respect, patience.

Interviewer [00:17:56] Can I ask you why you list these things? For example, why do you think curiosity is an important element for you in a relationship? Why is respect important?

Speaker [00:18:07] It seems to me that if someone is real, if someone is in a quality relationship, if you really love (sevmek) someone. You know, you wonder about the other person's interests, why they are interested in it and you want to get into that quality time and you want to get into that time when you spend that quality time or you try to understand, you try to learn because it is a part of him/her. For example, [Partner's Name] loves [interest] and right now we play a [interest] every week in the evenings. And while it was normally such a black concept, now I'm starting to like it too. It's a little bit of a thing. Honestly, I feel like she creates a cycle. You know, you wonder because you like her, or you listen to her because you respect her, so she adds something to you. I feel like they are all concepts that already play with each other.

Interviewer [00:19:13] So what is love for you?

Speaker [00:19:16] Uh, I don't know to be honest. I mean, I can say it is a combination of some molecular reactions. Well, but love (sevgi) sounds like something else. There is a big difference between the two.

Interviewer [00:19:39] So how do you see love (sevgi)?

Speaker [00:19:45] Love is something that comes from within, you know, those concepts that I mentioned, when I say love (sevgi), I mean family love (sevgi), love (aşk). Love (aşk) can be love (aşk) as passion, love (aşk) as affection (sevgi). The combination of these may perhaps make a quality relationship.

Interviewer [00:20:04] Uh-huh.

Speaker [00:20:08] So. Maybe we can say love is this molecular reaction + love (sevgi).

Interviewer [00:20:18] So what do you think the message is that we said love as molecular passion and we said love as love. What do you think are the parts that differentiate love (sevgi) and love (aşk)?

Speaker [00:20:35] Sexual attraction.

Interviewer [00:20:38] Uh-huh. So how do you think a person can understand love (aşk) as love (sevgi)? In which processes can he/she say okay I feel love (sevgi), I feel love (aşk)?

Speaker [00:20:54] I feel like that happens over time. It's really a lot, I feel like [Movie Name], but it's too much like that. After experiencing a few complexes, after you feel how you resolve it, you know, the feelings we have for the other person also differentiate. Because, you know, at first it's just sexual attraction or there's a curiosity, something happens, then you experience something, huh, okay, we've reached a solution. Therefore, how do I feel, how will I start to behave from now on, and so on, and these chain reactions start to happen all the time. I mean, after spending time together and after a while, if the positives are more, I don't know how it happens, but it seems to me that it evolves into love (sevgi).

Interviewer [00:22:01] Well, for example, you mentioned these positives. What do you think these positive processes are? As love (sevgi), which then turns into love (aşk).

Speaker [00:22:14] In that sense, your commitment increases.

Interviewer [00:22:18] No, how do you do it?

Speaker [00:22:22] Materials. Something that comes from the environment. When we put those two people in different environments, how they react together, when I say reactions, it can be approval from the environment. But also scales like when you put your feelings to that partner in that restaurant, what do you feel when you eat? How do you feel when they explain something or how do you feel about what you tell them or what they tell you? How do you feel when you do or don't do any activities together, when you're apart from them, and so on.

Interviewer [00:23:23] Right. So how important do you think love is in a relationship?

Speaker [00:23:31] It is important.

Interviewer [00:23:34] Well, for example, if we evaluate out of 100, what percentage do you think is important?

Speaker [00:23:49] I would say 70%.

Interviewer [00:23:51] Okay. So how do you know if your partner loves you?

Speaker [00:24:02] You can tell. Uh-huh. In general... In general, I feel like everyone is always questioning it, I mean not everyone but most people. I mean, I feel like the question is asked if she doesn't love me and usually they try to prove otherwise.

Interviewer [00:24:37] Uh-huh. So is it something like, you ask if she doesn't love me and if the answer is no, do you feel like she does?

Speaker [00:24:52] I guess you can tell from the body language.

Interviewer [00:24:55] For example, what kind of body language?

Speaker [00:25:04] She wants to be close, she wants to hug, she wants to talk all the time. Other than that. If we think of this love (sevgi) as that component, you know, she does things other than passion. She makes you feel cared for, she makes you feel valued, she supports you. She wants to spend time together.

Interviewer [00:25:52] Well, for example, you said that she shows care. In your answer, can you give concrete examples of this in your relationship?

Speaker [00:26:06] Then for example, my caring is usually acting service. Just cooking or something like that, you know, very, very simple, you know, I mean, that person is thirsty at night, you know, putting a pitcher of water next to her every night, and so on and so forth. Like taking care of that person's needs.

Interviewer [00:26:38] Hmm. Again in your book you talked about spending time together. For example, what do you think are the elements that make a pleasant time? How do you like to spend time in your relationship?

Speaker [00:26:54] So I like to discover new things, experience new things. At the same time, you know, according to the fashion, if you are very tired, you just want to sit and watch TV or you just want to cuddle. So I think it depends on your wants and needs at that time.

Interviewer [00:27:24] Okay. So what would you say are the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker [00:27:31] In my current relationship or in general?

Interviewer [00:27:36] Uh, yes, in your current relationship.

Speaker [00:27:52] I mean it's not difficult but funny. For example, [Partner's Name] is such a well-known person and I am such an introverted person. But well, every once in a while when we are walking on the street, there is this and that, okay, we need to talk to that person too. But I want to say that I'm unhappy right now, I want to say, wait a minute, what's going on? Apart from that, a lot of things are spatial in terms of difficulty, I shouldn't say difficulty. She lives on the [Location] side, I live on the [Location] side. I have to change continents all the time, that is a difficulty, frankly. That's why I spend a little more time here, because [City] isour life (????)

Speaker [00:28:51] That's why I feel a little bit like I'm ignoring my friends on the [Location] side. Apart from that. You know, in general. The situation in [Country A], the economic situation, this and that. Is it a problem in my relationship or am I angry because I can't spend money right now because I am unemployed? You know, it is difficult to distinguish between these two in general. These are the ones.

Interviewer [00:29:26] Okay. Well, for example, you mentioned the situation in [Country A]. Do you think, for example, this situation in [Country A], these contextual situations, are reflected in your relationship quality, do you think so?

Speaker [00:29:39] Yes.

Interviewer [00:29:40] Hmm. So how is it reflected?

Speaker [00:29:44] Because my living spaces are constantly restricted, economically, socially, politically, in the neighborhood. It already restricts me. Even though I don't want to reflect on it, when I can't go to a crowded place or something like that because it's in your head all the time, it can reflect in your relationship.

Interviewer [00:30:18] So do you and your partner fight?

Speaker [00:30:21] Yes.

Interviewer [00:30:23] How often do these fights happen?

Speaker [00:30:28] Mm-hmm. I don't have a concept of time. So I guess I can't answer exactly. Pardon me.

Interviewer [00:30:45] What if we think about it like [1-5] times a week and [1-5] times a month.

Speaker [00:30:52] Maybe [1-5] times a week. That is, if we live together a lot, I mean, right now, for example, I've been with her for a week, it happens [1-5] times a week.

Interviewer [00:31:04] Okay. So what are these fights usually about?

Speaker [00:31:12] Yeah, usually. Because it's not about the same thing. You know, when there is a problem, we can do something directly. For example, what happened at first was that I lived in my own house, I mean, I have my own house and there is a house here. Now do I have to do the cleaning here? I will clean when I go home, so will I spend my whole life cleaning? I had that space problem and according to [Partner's Name], you know, you live here, okay, then we do the cleaning together or something like that. There was a situation where maybe she perceived it as sloppy and I was confused or something like that.

Interviewer [00:32:10] We were talking about the subject of the fights.

Speaker [00:32:13] Or you know, the other person, how should I put it. If the other person feels ignored or if there is some other misunderstanding, if there is a problem in communication, usually these can be problems. But in this case we solve it by communicating.

Interviewer [00:32:44] Okay. You said we solve it by communicating. What kind of communication do you use to solve your fights?

Speaker [00:32:55] By saying it instantly. I mean, because I feel like, frankly, in other relationships in my other life, romantic or not. When you don't say it immediately, when you say it a week later, a day later, other things come into play. Since we are already full for that [1-5] week or [1-5] days, it is reflected in your actions and the other person is already aware of the events. Heh, it just happened yesterday. For example, I felt a little bit bad, which I probably felt bad because I was on my period that day. And you know, I said it directly, we talked about it directly. Since we were in a crowded environment, we even exchanged messages with each other and it was solved and we continued our lives instantly. Immediately, directly, honestly, I mean, I honestly feel like there is no point in stalling.

Interviewer [00:34:02] Right. So apart from telling instantly, what do you think are the other ways to maintain your relationship?

Speaker [00:34:22] Honestly, what works for me is to talk to someone, to write it down, I mean, in order to understand what I am going through in the big picture, it is useful for me to get away a little bit and make sense of it. Because otherwise you can get lost in the relationship. A relationship can be built only on reaction without realizing it. Maybe it's because I try to do the opposite of what my family does. It's better to see the bigger picture, it's better to be in the background and when I stay by myself and evaluate things, and at the same time, when I talk to my partner after doing this, huh huh, I saw that it was useful.

Interviewer [00:35:28] Well, for example, you talked about seeing the big picture in the relationship. Can you give concrete examples of this by talking or writing?

Speaker [00:35:42] In one of my relationships, we were really doing such a monthly thing. You know, we were sitting every month, what do we think about this relationship, what could have gone better, blah blah blah. it's quite like a company. It sounds very cold when you think about it at first, but it really worked. We really started to listen to each other more clearly. Now I'm trying to do it a little bit more organically in quotes, to be honest. Like, I did this this week, I liked this, it would have been better if I hadn't done that, blah blah blah.

Interviewer [00:36:35] Well, for example, you said to like it. For example, what are the behaviors that you like in your relationships that increase your relationship quality? Or decrease it.

Speaker [00:36:51] For example, we are a very socializing couple. For example, when I meet someone new, I like it very much when they make a very sudden sweet introduction about me with their friends. Well, this is something that touches you too, you know, when she makes an introduction or speaks in a more sincere way, something that shows that she is listening. Other than that, I like... I like doing nice things, doing new things. Going to events, going to exhibitions, talking about a book together, [Partner's Name] plays [interest] very well, very professionally. But when I play [interest] with her, I like it very much when she is very patient, looking at all her moves and playing with me. Maybe I can call it quality time. And you know, moments that make you feel that she really cares about you when she could have acted differently.

Interviewer [00:38:18] Can you explain this a little more? For example with concrete examples.

Speaker [00:38:22] She may not play [interest], for example. She might say, "Oh, I'm so bored" or something like that. Another example right now, for example, I'm having a stomach ache, I'm at an event, she said "I can come and stand next to you, okay, I can stand next to you," something, something. You know, she can socialize differently at that time, no problem. I didn't tell her to be with me all day, but she decided to do something like that, for example.

Interviewer [00:39:05] So would you say this is good for your relationship?

Speaker [00:39:10] I would.

Interviewer [00:39:12] May I ask why you think that?

Speaker [00:39:18] I wasn't sure at first but now I am. Because it's a relationship where I can build something together, I don't know if I put it right. I mean, a relationship where I can learn new things together, where I can build something really start-up, but at the same time I can do it emotionally, or if not at first, but now we can talk and communicate in a proper honest way.

Interviewer [00:40:07] You talked about both building something materially and building something emotionally together. Can you give examples of these two?

Speaker [00:40:22] Materially, for example, I learn chess. Emotionally, we build love (sevgi). It's going to be a very, well, it's going to be a very short answer, but I like to see that thing, to be honest. I mean. Seeing my feelings for her change, you know, it's a bumpy process after all. Like in every relationship. So it's a good feeling to see that feeling change.

Interviewer [00:41:05] So did this relationship change you?

Speaker [00:41:05] Yes.

Interviewer [00:41:06] In what way did it change you?

Speaker 2 [00:41:19] I mean, I feel like it changed my behavior outside the relationship rather than inside the relationship, to be honest. The [Nationality] business world, some of the actions I took in the business world in [Country A] offered a different perspective, maybe because of her political stance, because of the decisions she had previously made about her business. And it caused me to take bullshit, I can't find the Turkish word for it. It reminded me of my own value, frankly professionally. At the same time, I don't know, I don't know how to say it in a different way when I have a different conversation with people. I don't know how to say it, but maybe I can say that it made me different in my socialization. You know, I normally like to do much more, I mean, I like to have deep one-on-one conversations, and I still continue to do so, but this is not something. It reminded me a little bit more of the importance of knowing a lot of people and having a connection. I can say that I started doing this.

Interviewer [00:43:00] So do you think your partner changed during the relationship?

Speaker [00:43:06] That's a good question. I think she changed.

Interviewer [00:43:13] In what way?

Speaker [00:43:18] I mean her previous relationship was a bit traumatic as far as I understand. [redacted]. I hope that maybe she started to feel safer. She started to talk more, I hope she will feel more comfortable afterwards.

Interviewer [00:44:11] So do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker [00:44:15] What do we mean by safe?

Interviewer [00:44:18] We're asking about the concept of being able to open up to your partner about your experiences, your thoughts and your identity without fear of judgment or retaliation. And also the expectation that the other will offer you comfort and compassion in moments of danger or distress.

Speaker [00:44:36] Yes yes then.

Interviewer [00:44:38] May I ask why you think that?

Speaker [00:44:43] Experience. So it includes things that we have experienced before.

Interviewer [00:44:49] So what kind of experiences?

Speaker [00:44:58] I don't know, I don't feel judged when I talk about myself. You know, nothing happened in terms of physical safety. After all, I can't say anything to her, I mean, on the contrary, in such environments, I would be such an unnecessary protector. I mean, generally experience.

Interviewer [00:45:30] Okay. Now I will share my screen with you. If I ask you that my partner usually really listens to me, what would you give on a scale of 1 not at all true to 9 completely true?

Speaker [00:45:55] It depends a lot on the mood. I would say 7 for her.

Interviewer [00:45:58] 7, okay. And if I were to say that my partner is usually sensitive to my needs, what would you give on a scale of 1 not at all true to 9 completely true?

Speaker [00:46:11] 8.

Interviewer [00:46:12] 8, okay. Can I ask you why you answered seven to your first question that my partner usually really listens to me?

Speaker [00:46:27] ii. Distracted- so yes she listens. But when she is distracted she doesn't listen.

Interviewer [00:46:37] Okay. So this is when she is distracted.

Interviewer [00:46:37] Okay. So, for example, do these distracted times decrease or increase the quality of your relationship? Do you feel like that?

Speaker [00:46:50] Of course.

Interviewer [00:46:54] Okay. And can you give concrete examples of when this happens?

Interviewer [00:46:54] Yes.

Speaker [00:47:04] It happened yesterday, it's a bit fresh, well. I know that she is very busy in her head, so I can't do anything, but yesterday I felt that I was not being listened to while I was saying something. Well, you know, when I talk like this, if she has too many things in her head, the subject changes, and I do the same thing, frankly, I don't do anything for her, but in general, when I start to talk and try to explain my own thoughts, she gets distracted by something else or looks elsewhere, etc.

Interviewer [00:47:53] So why did you give your answer and not 6 or 8?

Speaker [00:47:59] Intention.

Interviewer [00:48:01] Can you explain a little bit more?

Speaker 2 [00:48:04] Not because she doesn't care about me or my thoughts. I know she's distracted, not because she's not listening to me, but because she's not listening to anyone at that time, so it's not six.

Interviewer [00:48:21] Okay. So can I ask you why you answered eight to our second question, my partner is usually sensitive to my needs?

Speaker [00:48:32] Because she is.

Interviewer [00:48:35] Can you give concrete examples?

Speaker [00:48:36] Why not 9. Because I don't think we can ever be that selfless. For example, for the last month I've been trying to quit antidepressants and there are a lot of things that she has helped me a lot during that time. I mean, for example, I sleep more than [11-15] hours a day, which is ridiculous, and I can't help but she is very patient, something that I know she really doesn't like. She likes to get up early in the morning. And I, as a person who woke up at 12 o'clock in the morning (the speaker was not understood). Well, she knows that I go through such a process.

Interviewer [00:49:42] Okay.

Speaker [00:49:45] You're stuck. Can you hear me?

Interviewer [00:49:46] Yes, I can hear you. I hope you don't mind me asking and if it's sensitive for you to share, feel free to say so. But as part of the project we would also like to know about our physical intimacy as a couple. How often do you have sexual intercourse these days?

Speaker [00:50:09] It varies a little bit, to be honest. Because I am on antidepressants. So [1-5] times a week max.

Interviewer [00:50:24] Yes. So how satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker [00:50:41] I am satisfied when it happens. But right now I think my desires are in such a ridiculous state. Sometimes I can feel asexual like nothing because it's not there. It can be the other way around. So maybe we can say that it's complicated (it's not clear what the speaker said).

Interviewer [00:51:14] Okay. So how important do you think sexuality is in a relationship?

Speaker [00:51:26] How much. 7 out of 10.

Interviewer [00:51:39] Now I'm going to share one screen with you. If I asked you how satisfied you are with your relationship in general, which of the following options would you choose?

Speaker [00:51:55] Two from the last.

Interviewer [00:51:57] Very satisfied.

Speaker [00:51:57] Uh, yes.

Interviewer [00:51:58] So how would you rate your satisfaction in your relationship? On this scale, 0 is not satisfied at all, 10 is completely satisfied.

Speaker [00:52:09] 8.

Interviewer [00:52:11] 8, okay. May I ask why you answered 8?

Speaker [00:52:24] There are areas for improvement.

Interviewer [00:52:27] What exactly do we mean by development areas?

Speaker [00:52:35] It means that all the concepts we are talking about have the potential to be better.

Interviewer [00:53:03] Well, for example, you said there is potential for improvement. In terms of the topics we talked about. Well, for example, which subject do you think you need to give importance to in order to have the opportunity to improve on a subject that will increase your relationship quality? Is there a development area where you say that if we do this, our relationship quality will actually increase?

Speaker [00:53:32] I think this is a little bit related to the improvement of environmental factors, to be honest.

Interviewer [00:53:42] What do we mean by environmental factors? I'm sorry, I didn't hear you.

Speaker [00:53:48] [Factor], you know, the state of constantly questioning yourself. We both have it right now. I don't think about it in terms of our relationship. I think it will be much different with the investments we make in our relationship when we go to a point where we both feel safe.

Interviewer [00:54:14] So do you think your relationship has met your expectations?

Speaker [00:54:24] I honestly had no expectations. In fact. I was in a really unpredictable period, so yes.

Interviewer [00:54:37] Okay, we are about to finish but I want to summarize what we talked about in the last hour. So that there is no omission or mistake. We started with demographic questions. You said that you are [26-30] years old, you have been with a partner for [1-5] months. You live with your [name]e, you said, your relationship started at a [event]. Just as you were getting up with your partner with his fan and then your relationship developed together. You said that compared to your friends' relationships, especially hetero relationships, it was more honest, you spent much more time together, you could talk directly when there was a problem. Compared to your romantic relationships in the past, you said that you could not make such a comparison, that you had good relationships and problematic relationships, that you did not evaluate the quality of the relationship on such a scale. You said that in your problematic relationships you have a drug addiction, but in your good relationships you have a relationship that I can speak clearly, a relationship that does not involve ego. When we asked you what makes a relationship of high quality for you, you mentioned the importance of not feeling pressured, not being ignored, resilience, making effort, being friends. When we asked about the most important things in a relationship for you, you said communication, curiosity, respect, patience. When we asked about love for you, you made two distinctions: love as love, love and passion, love as passion and apology, love as frequent and love as love. You said that love is actually a molecular reaction, love comes more from within. When we asked you how we understand that your partner loves you, you said that they want to be close, they want to hug you, they care for you. You said that sometimes there are fights in your relationship but you resolve these fights by communicating immediately. In other ways of maintaining the relationship, you talked about the importance of looking at the relationship from a big picture, sometimes by writing, sometimes by talking. This is what you said when you changed your behavior outside the relationship, even if not in terms of the relationship. Especially in terms of socializing. You said that your partner also changed in terms of more self-disclosure. You said that she feels safe in this relationship. You answered seven to the question that my partner usually really listens to me, and you said that of course there are situations where he is distracted, and these situations are reflected in the quality of your relationship, but what is important here is the intention. You said that you have sexual intercourse [1-5] times a week these days and that your sexual life is important in a relationship as seven out of 10. When we asked

about our satisfaction in the relationship, you said that there are areas for improvement, especially environmental factors such as unemployment, constant self-questioning and situations that may increase your complaints. You said that you did not have an expectation from the relationship and that for this reason, you actually met your expectation at the beginning. Is there anything else you would like to add?

Speaker [00:58:01] I guess not.

Interviewer [00:58:01] Okay. Thank you very much. Now before we finish we would like to talk to you about how we will handle the data. As a research project we want to be as transparent as ethically possible. Therefore, we would like to know which data sharing option is most suitable for you. The first option is to share parts of the transcript of our interview. None of these transcripts will contain information that can identify you. Thus, it is a de-identified interview and our transcript can be read by other researchers. The second option, if you don't mind and if you want to be a little more daring, is to share the entire interview transcript, stripped of sensitive and overly identifying details and anonymized. There is a slim chance that someone who knows you will be able to piece together the details of the interview transcript and narrow down who they believe you are among colleagues. But I would like to reiterate that no sensitive information will be shared. All information will be shared anonymously. Which of the two options do you prefer?

Speaker [00:59:12] Maybe the second one.

Interviewer [00:59:13] Okay. Thank you very much again for participating in this study. This is a big study that is also being done in other countries like Brazil, Netherlands, Philippines, USA. For this study to be successful, we have one last request for you. We ask you to suggest 2 close people in your life as candidates. We will ask them to suggest other couples you don't know who might be interested in this study. In this way, we aim to reach a variety of participants. Is this suitable for you?

Speaker [00:59:47] It is suitable.

Interviewer [00:59:48] Okay. Thank you again. I will contact you again today or tomorrow for these couples. If you reach out to these couples in advance and if they are interested, you can share the contact number with me. Finally, I will also send you a survey in a moment. This survey takes about 10 minutes at most and I will ask you to fill in even eighty-two codes in this survey. Thank you very much again in order to keep your data confidential. I hope it was enjoyable for you as well. Your opinions and perspectives are very valuable for us. Thank you very much.

Speaker 3 [01:00:26] See you.